JAKOB BROUNSTEIN

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jakobbrounstein.github.io

POSITIONS

Economist, Revelio Labs — May 2026 - Present
Postdoctoral Scholar, Institute for Fiscal Studies — September 2023 - May 2026

AFFILIATIONS

Research Affiliate, Institute for Fiscal Studies — May 2026 - Present
Research Affiliate, Skatteforsk - Centre for Tax Research — January 2025 - Present

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics, UC Berkeley — 2023
Primary field: Public economics
Secondary fields: Labor economics, development economics

Bachelor of Arts, Columbia University — 2017
Summa Cum Laude

Bachelor of Arts, L'Institut d'Etudes Politiques de Paris (Sciences Po) — 2016

WORKING PAPERS

The Transparency Tax: Discouraging firm ownership via tax havens (with Bachas, P. and Bajaña, A.)
R&R at the American Economic Journal: Economic Policy.

The labor market impacts of unconditional housing out of homelessness (with Wieselthier, J.).
R&R at the Journal of Urban Economics.

The Pink Tax: Why do women pay more? (with Barnes, K.)
R&R at the Journal of Public Economics.

Tax Noncompliance Penalties: Evidence and Optimality (with Alstadsæter, A. and Scheuerer, J.)

The Role of Tax Preparers in Individual Tax Optimization (with Avivi, H., Bilicka, K., Lobel, F., and Yuskavage, A.)

Can Countries Unilaterally Mitigate Tax Haven Usage? Evidence from Ecuadorian Transaction Tax Data

OTHER WORKS IN PROGRESS

Conspicuous Consumption and Tax Compliance: Evidence from Vehicle Wealth (with Alstadsæter, A., Lizzaraga, R., And Feldman, N.)

Behavioral Responses to One-Time Fiscal Policies: Theory and Evidence from the DRC (with Bergeron, A. and Bolte, L.)

The Distributional Incidence of Charitability (with Kancherla, K., Karol, S., Landais, C., McPherson, C., Muñoz, M., and Reck, D.)

PUBLICATIONS

"What Happens When you Give Money to Panhandlers? The Case of Downtown Manhattan". Dordick G., O'Flaherty B., Brounstein J., Sinha, S., Yoo J.. Journal of Urban Economics 108. p. 107-123. 2018.

"Good Panhandling and Bad: How to Encourage the Good and Discourage the Bad". Dordick G., O'Flaherty B., Brounstein J., Sinha, S.. European Journal of Homelessness 12:1. p. 87-112. 2018.

POLICY REPORTS

"Veikart for en mer treffsikker tilleggsskatt: Kunnskapsgrunnlag og anbefalinger" [A roadmap for better-targeted tax penalties: Evidence and recommendations] (in Norwegian). Alstadsæter, A., Brounstein, J., Jacobsen, S. K., Scheuerer, J. Skatteforsk Note 11-2026. Commissioned by the Norwegian Ministry of Justice and Public Security. 2026.

INVITED SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

Seminars: EU Tax Observatory and Paris School of Economics, University of Reading, University of Manchester, Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Oxford University, Norwegian University of Life Sciences, University of Toronto, University of Barcelona, VATT Institute & Aalto University, EU Tax Observatory and Paris School of Economics, Indiana University O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs

Conferences: Open Ownership Research Symposium on Beneficial Ownership Transparency (2026), Paris School of Economics conference: From Secrecy to Transparency: The End of Hidden Wealth? (2026), National Tax Association (2023, 2025), World Bank/ODI Global/IFS Public Finance Conference (2025), European Economic Association Annual Meeting (2025), International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress (2023-2025), Oxford Centre for Business Taxation Academic Symposium (2024-2025), National Bureau of Economic Research Public Economics Spring Meeting (2025), National Bureau of Economic Research Economic Analysis of Business Taxation Spring Meeting (2025), Urban Economic Association Annual European Meeting (2025), Stavanger Tax Workshop (2023-2024), Irish Public Economics Workshop (2024), Joint UK + Norwegian Fiscal Studies Conference (2024), UNU-WIDER Workshop on Illicit Financial Flows (2022)

TEACHING, MENTORING, AND TUTORING EXPERIENCE

Global Inequality and Growth (Econ 133), *as teaching assistant* — Spring 2022

Introduction to Econometrics (Econ 141), *as teaching assistant* — Fall 2020

UC Berkeley Undergraduate Mentorship Program, *as graduate student mentor* — Summer 2019 - August 2022

Economic Analysis–Micro (Econ 100), *as tutor* — Fall 2018 - Spring 2019

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Referee for: American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review, City and Community, Journal of Human Capital, Journal of Public Economics, National Tax Journal, Review of Economics and Statistics

Conferences/seminars organized and scientific committees:
Conference organizer: Institute for Fiscal Studies Postdoctoral Alumni Workshop (2024)
Scientific program grader: International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress (2026); European Economic Association Annual Congress (2025)
Session chair: European Economic Association Annual Congress (2025), National Tax Association 116th Annual Meeting (2023)

Other acknowledgments: Top-10 Forecaster in the Social Science Prediction Platform (SSPP) 2025

SELECTED FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

IFS Bid Grant	2025
TaxDev Small Bid Grant	2024
International Tax and Public Finance Best PhD Student Paper Award	2023
Center for Effective Global Action Development Economics Challenge Award	2022
UC Berkeley Department of Economics Summer Grant	2022
United Nations University Illicit Financial Flows Research Grant	2021
Center for Effective Global Action Development Economics Challenge Award	2021
Burch Center Grant in Public Finance	2021
UC Berkeley Department of Economics Summer Grant	2021

REFERENCES

Gabriel Zucman, UC Berkeley and Paris School of Economics
email: zucman@gmail.com

Annette Alstadsæter, Norwegian University of Life Sciences
email: annette.alstadsater@nmbu.no

Pierre Bachas, The World Bank
email: pierrebachas@gmail.com

ADDITIONAL BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

Gender: Male
Citizenship: Canada, USA
Date of Birth: 9 May 1995

Language: English (C2), French (C1), Spanish (C1), Portuguese (B1), Mandarin & Simplified Chinese (HSK 3), Turkish (A2)

Hobbies: Music composition and performance, Sailing, hiking and camping, mycology, cooking